- During many meetings with King Hussein, whenever the name of a Palestinian leader came up, he would let out a despairing sigh. And as I noted earlier, on the eve of the signing of the Oslo Accords, King Hussein told Prime Minister Rabin, “Until now I’m the one who has had to suffer Arafat’s wet kisses—now it’s your turn!”
- In a meeting with another leader, King Hussein described the Palestinians as “the headache of the Arab world.”

The meetings described above, as well as many others, were secret and attended by only a few individuals, without any recordings or written records. Therefore, I believe that the attitudes that were expressed toward the Palestinians and their leaders were authentic, unlike those expressed in documented official meetings where speakers are naturally cautious in their statements.

At the conclusion of the First Gulf War in 1991, during which Arafat supported Saddam Hussein, the ruler of Kuwait expelled, within forty-eight hours, about three hundred thousand Palestinians who were living there. Since then, they have not been allowed to return to Kuwait.

In light of the failure of bilateral negotiations, the time has come to consider a different direction—a parallel arrangement that will include a permanent solution to the conflict between Israel and the Palestinians and that will be achieved through negotiations involving a coalition of those Arab states that have agreed in principle to peace with Israel. The vehicle through which to advance such negotiations already exists, in the form of the Saudi Initiative of 2002, which was officially adopted by the Arab League in 2003 and has since been periodically ratified by the League.

To understand the potential for success of such negotiations, we must go back to a ceremony that was held more than twenty years ago in Cairo. On May 4, 1994, Israeli prime minister Yitzhak Rabin and PLO chairman Yasser Arafat were invited to Cairo to sign the Gaza-Jericho Agreement. This agreement, which was the continuation and implementation of the Declaration of Principles signed on the White House lawn on September 13, 1993, established the self-governing Palestinian Authority (PA), with legislative powers, and the transfer of the Gaza Strip and the Jericho area to the Palestinians. Egyptian president Hosni Mubarak and the foreign ministers of the United States and Russia were invited to attend the ceremony as witnesses.